

Ask Matthew

Need a ----- ? Ask Matthew

PROJECT SPECIFICATION & DEVELOPER BRIEF

1. Project Overview & Core Vision

Ask Matthew is an innovative, UK-focused services directory designed to transform how consumers find local businesses and how service providers source premium leads. Moving away from cluttered, ad-heavy legacy directories, Ask Matthew presents an entirely interactive, conversational web interface fronted by Matthew—a soft, smiley, and exceptionally helpful cartoon robot mascot.

Crucially, this platform utilizes a **Non-AI architecture**. The interaction framework is built upon strict, pre-programmed rule-based decision trees and precise keyword matching. This eliminates high AI API overheads, guarantees total predictability, ensures blazing-fast directory processing, and entirely mitigates the risks of "hallucinations" or erratic outputs.

Core Deliverable Summary: A highly responsive web application combining an engaging multi-turn conversational chat workflow with a traditional fallback search directory. The solution must handle a highly structured, tiered multi-location taxonomy of UK businesses, complete with a automated Stripe billing engine and localized geo-routing.

2. The Dual-Interface Architecture

To capture different user behaviors, the platform must seamlessly integrate two distinct front-end experiences backed by a single central database layer.

2.1 Interface A: The Conversational Chat Experience (Primary)

When an end-user loads the homepage, they are immediately placed into a full-screen, clean chat window designed to replicate a modern mobile messaging app (such as WhatsApp or iMessage), matching the white, crisp blue, and vibrant red palette.

Matthew's Static Opening Gambit:

"What's the plan? Kitchen remodel? Birthday party? Weekly aesthetic & upkeep? Cleaner? The possibilities are endless. Need a.... Ask Matthew"

A. The Button-Driven Tree (Recommended Flow)

Directly beneath the opening greeting, the UI must dynamically inject predefined, clickable choice buttons corresponding to macro-level service sectors (e.g., [Home & Trades], [Events & Parties]). As the user taps through successive layers, the application narrows the criteria down to a single service discipline and requests a UK Postcode.

B. Text-Input Keyword Mapping (Search Alternative)

If the user prefers to type natural text into the chat bar (e.g., *"I need a pro to fix a leaky pipe in my bathroom"*), the backend must filter the string against an arrayed dictionary of hardcoded synonyms.

- **Example Syntax Evaluation:** String contains ["pipe", "leaky", "tap", "radiator", "plumber"] → Instantly match user to node: **Plumbing & Heating**.
- **Fallback Logic:** If zero keyword matches occur, Matthew must respond gracefully: *"I didn't quite catch that! Are you looking for Home Trades, Events, Lifestyle, or Wellness? Click an option below so I can help you out."*

2.2 Interface B: Manual Search & "Matthew's Choice" (Fallback)

Directly below the primary chatbot interface, a clean link/action bar must read: **"Prefer to browse? Search Matthew's directory yourself and see Matthew's Choice."** Clicking this shifts the layout or redirects smoothly to a highly refined, traditional grid search interface.

This UI allows users to select a category from a dropdown and input a UK postcode. The resulting layout split is highly prioritized to incentivize monetization:

- **The "Matthew's Choice" Top Section:** A high-visibility, visually premium spotlight zone pinned to the top of the search results page. This section displays matching **Premium Tier** members exclusively as polished cards with custom styling and badges.
- **The Standard Results:** Located directly underneath the spotlight zone, rendering **Plus Tier** listings next, and standard **Basic Tier** listings at the very bottom.

3. Comprehensive Service Taxonomy (The Database Schema)

The database must categorize service providers into the following exhaustive UK-wide taxonomy. Each leaf node represents a definitive business classification that can be indexed, searched, and filtered via postcode radiuses.

Branch A: Home, Trades & Construction

- **Building & Structural:** General Builders, Bricklayers, Extensions & Conversions, Loft Specialists, Plasterers, Damp Proofing, Scaffolding.
- **Plumbing & Heating:** Emergency Plumbers, Gas Safe Engineers, Boiler Servicing, Underfloor Heating.
- **Electrical & Smart Home:** Domestic Electricians, EV Charger Installers, Home Automation, Security & CCTV.
- **Carpentry & Interiors:** Carpenters & Joiners, Kitchen Fitters, Bathroom Installers, Painters & Decorators, Tilers, Flooring Specialists.
- **External & Outdoors:** Roofers, Chimney Sweeps, Gutter Cleaners, Landscape Gardeners, Tree Surgeons, Fencing Contractors, Driveway & Patio Layers, Handymen.

Branch B: Domestic & Lifestyle Services

- **Cleaning Operations:** Domestic Home Cleaners, Deep/End-of-Tenancy Cleaners, Window Cleaners, Carpet & Upholstery Cleaners, Oven Cleaners.
- **Property Upkeep & Safety:** Locksmiths, Waste Removal & Rubbish Clearance, Pest Control.
- **Logistics & Logistics:** Man & Van Services, Removals Agencies, Packing Services, Storage Units.
- **Pet Care Ecology:** Veterinary Practices, Dog Walkers, Pet Groomers, Catteries & Kennels, House Pet Sitters.
- **Child & Family Care:** Nannies & Au Pairs, Babysitters, Registered Childminders.

Branch C: Events, Parties & Entertainment

- **Planning & Venues:** Wedding Planners, Event Coordinators, Local Venue Hire.
- **Catering & Hospitality:** Mobile Event Caterers, Private Chefs, Mobile Bars, Bespoke Cake Designers.
- **Entertainment:** Event DJs, Live Bands & Singers, Children's Entertainers, Magicians, Photo Booth Hire.
- **Production & Decor:** Event Photographers, Videographers, Florists, Balloon Artists, Marquee & Tent Hire.

Branch D: Personal Care, Wellness & Style

- **Hair & Aesthetics:** Hair Salons, Mobile Hairdressers, Barbers, Beauty Salons, Nail Technicians, Makeup Artists, Tattoo Artists.
- **Fitness & Health:** Personal Trainers, Yoga & Pilates Instructors, Physiotherapists, Chiropractors, Massage Therapists.
- **Garment Support:** Tailors & Alterations, Wardrobe Stylists, Dry Cleaning Delivery.

Branch E: Automotive, Transport & Training

- **Vehicle Maintenance:** Mobile Mechanics, Garages (MOT & Servicing), Car Body Repairs, Tyre Fitters, Mobile Valeting & Detailing.
- **Logistics & Driving:** Local Taxi Firms, Private Chauffeurs, Coach/Minibus Hire, Driving Instructors.
- **Tuition & Lessons:** Academic Tutors (Primary/Secondary), Music Teachers, Language Instructors.

4. Monetization Model & Database Tier Logic

The platform operates on a recurring monthly subscription model. Businesses register, select their tier, manage their profiles, and settle billing natively. The developer must structure listings according to these exact parameters:

Subscription Tier	Monthly Cost	UI Data Structure & Limits	Sorting & Matching Priority
Basic Tier BASIC	£3.00 / mo	Text-only. Business Name, Phone Number, concise 150-character text biography. No active outbound links, images, or review displays.	Bottom-level rendering priority. Sorted strictly alphabetically beneath all other higher tiers within a targeted postcode look-up.
Plus Tier PLUS	£15.00 / mo	Rich Profile. Custom active external links to Web/Socials, company logo branding, a photo portfolio gallery (up to 6 images), and 5-star customer review plugin. Appends a "Verified Provider" icon.	Mid-level priority. Surfaces automatically within the main conversational chat flow recommendation blocks above Basic Tier rows.
Premium Tier PREMIUM	£50.00 / mo	Full Rich Profile. Immediate visibility across chatbot outputs. Direct qualification for the "Matthew's Choice" Spotlight manual directory card slots. Includes automated lead generation hooks.	Absolute Priority. Programmed to populate the top spots. Features a dynamic random rotator algorithm if multiple premium accounts overlap in the same postcode coverage area.

4.1 High-Value Technical Engine: Direct Lead Routing (Premium Exclusive)

When an end-user completes a chatbot conversational stream to its conclusion (e.g., defines a concrete job spec like *"Emergency Plumber needed in M1"*) but does not immediately tap an outputted phone number, Matthew will transition to a lead capture interface:

"I can send your requirements directly to our top-rated local experts so you don't have to call around. Drop your name and mobile number below, and Matthew's Choice providers will text you custom quotes in minutes!"

Upon submission, the system must parse the location, check for Premium subscribers mapped to that specific postcode sector, and trigger an automated webhook executing instantaneous SMS and Email alerts to those specific Premium dashboards. **No Basic or Plus accounts may participate in this lead distribution stream.**

5. Technical Stack & Development Deliverables

Developers are permitted to quote via an optimized Low-Code framework (e.g., Bubble or Webflow combined with Landbot.io or dynamic embedded custom JS components) or a lightweight code stack (e.g., React frontend, Node.js, and PostgreSQL). The core technical deliverables must meet the following metrics:

5.1 Geolocation Postcode Engine

- Must integrate an indexing structure utilizing the ONS (Office for National Statistics) Postcode Directory or a scalable equivalent to handle radius search operations (e.g., 5, 10, 25 miles from user's input).
- User input validation must accept and sanitize standard UK postcode formats (e.g., EC1A, M1, G1 1XW) seamlessly.

5.2 Registration & Billing Self-Service Portal

- A secure onboarding flow enabling business owners to create accounts, map themselves to specific service categories (taxonomy nodes), input operational UK postcodes, and view their dashboard analytics.
- Native integration with **Stripe Billing/Subscriptions** to handle recurring monthly card payments, failed transactions, tier upgrades, and automated cancellations.

5.3 Core Performance & SEO Targets

- **Speed & Caching:** Pre-compiled rule trees and localized database queries must result in sub-200ms processing responses for button interactions.
- **Mobile-First Rendering:** Over 85% of traffic is estimated to occur via mobile devices. The chatbot web view must behave identically to a native app environment with fluid animation and smooth button interactions.
- **SEO Structural Mapping:** For the manual directory layout, the platform must systematically generate indexable, static programmatic URLs mapped by category and region (e.g., /cleaners/manchester) to guarantee organic Google indexing.